The stages of digestion are:

Mastication

Digestion of the food starts by the action of mastication(chewing) aided by teeth, a form of mechanical digestion.

Saliva secreted by the salivary glands which contains the following:

Salivary Amylase - Starts the digestion of starch

Mucus - Lubricates the food

Hydrogen carbonate - Maintains the ideal condition of PH (Alkaline) for Amylase to work

Digestion

Digestion is the breakdown of large insoluble food molecules into small water-soluble food molecules. So that they can be absorbed into the watery blood plasma. Digestion is a form of catabolism that is divided into mechanical and chemical digestion. The term mechanical digestion refers to the stepwise physical breakdown of large pieces of food into smaller pieces. In chemical digestion, enzymes break down food into the small molecules the body can use.

Absorption

95% of absorption of nutrients occurs in the small intestine. Water and minerals are reabsorbed by the colon .

Diseases related to digestive system

- Poisonings
- Diarrhea
- Constipation
- Diverticulitis
- Gastric Eosophageal Reflux Disorder (GERD)
- Peptic ulcers
- Cholelithiasis
- Cirrhosis of liver
- Hepatitis
- Colitis
- Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS)
- Cancer

1.7 Urinary system

Introduction

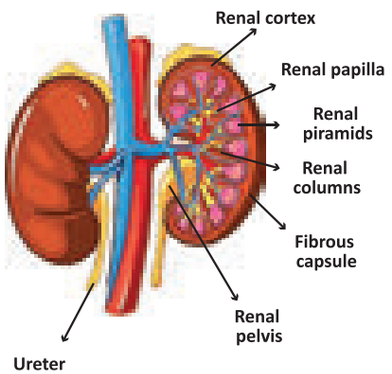
Urinary system also known as the renal system consist of the kidneys, ureters, bladder, and urethra. The purpose of the urinary system is to eliminate the excess water from the body, regulate blood volume and blood pressure, control and regulate the level of electrolytes and blood PH.

The parts of the urinary system

- Kidneys
- Ureters
- Bladder
- Urethra

Kidneys

The kidneys are bean shaped bilateral urinary organs that lie in the upper abdominal area in close proximity to the stomach and liver. The two main layers of the kidney are the medulla and the renal cortex. The medulla is the inside portion of the kidney and the cortex is the outer layer of the kidney. The kidneys are made up of millions of **nephrons**, the primary functional unit of the kidney.



Kidney

Ureters

The bilateral ureters connect the pelvis of each kidney to the bladder. The ureters consist

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